

Streamlining IT Procurement: Automating Standard Laptop Orders with Flow Designer

Project Documentation

1. Project Description

Problem Statement

The current IT procurement process lacks efficiency and automation, resulting in delays and manual effort, particularly when handling standard laptop orders. Standard laptop requests require configuration after approval, but manual task creation and assignment can lead to delays and oversight.

Proposed Solution

The project uses ServiceNow Flow Designer to automate the standard laptop procurement workflow. When a Standard Laptop request is submitted and approved, the flow automatically creates a Catalog Task, updates the task description, and assigns the task to the Hardware assignment group.

Project Objective

The main objectives are:

- Automate standard laptop procurement activities.
- Reduce manual intervention.
- Automatically create configuration tasks after approval.
- Assign configuration tasks to the Hardware team.
- Reduce user waiting time.
- Improve IT procurement efficiency and resource utilization.

2. User Story

As a member of the IT procurement team, I want a streamlined process for ordering standard laptops so that tasks are automatically generated and assigned to the Hardware team for configuration. This will ensure that laptops are promptly configured upon arrival, reducing user wait times and minimizing manual intervention.

3. Project Scenarios

Scenario 1 – Place a Standard Laptop Order

A user opens the Service Catalog, selects Hardware Standard Laptop, and clicks Order Now.

Scenario 2 – Approve the Request

The submitted Standard Laptop request is reviewed and approved.

Scenario 3 – Automatically Create Configuration Task

After approval, the Standard Laptop Task flow automatically creates a Catalog Task.

Scenario 4 – Assign Task to Hardware

The generated Catalog Task is automatically assigned to the Hardware assignment group.

Scenario 5 – Hardware Team Configures Laptop

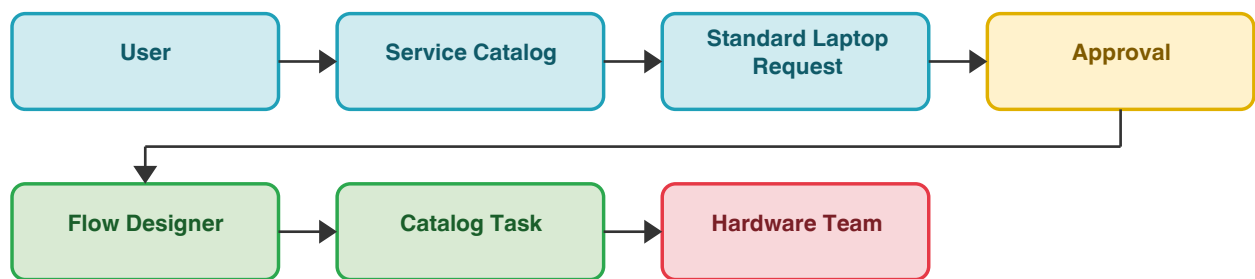
The Hardware team receives the task with the description:

“Laptop need to Configured”

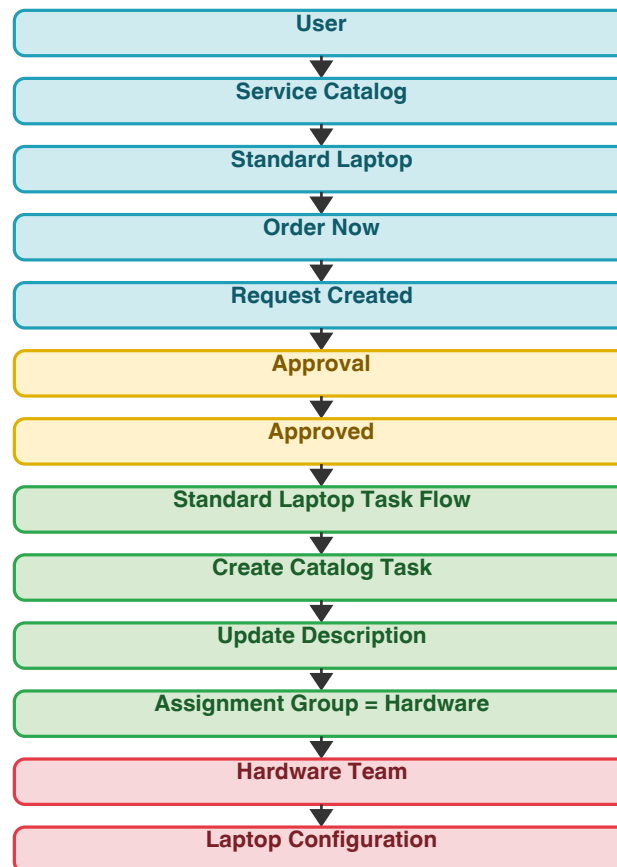
The team can then perform the required laptop configuration.

4. Technical Architecture

Architecture Components



Flow



5. Prerequisites

The following are required:

- ServiceNow Developer Instance.
- Access to ServiceNow.
- Flow Designer access.
- Service Catalog access.
- Hardware assignment group.
- Standard Laptop catalog item.
- Approval configuration.
- Maintain Items access.
- Appropriate ServiceNow roles/permissions.

6. Project Workflow / Milestones

Milestone 1 – Flow Creation

Activity: Create Standard Laptop Task Flow

1. Open ServiceNow.
2. Open All → Flow Designer.
3. Select New → Flow.
4. Enter the flow name **StandardLaptopTask**
5. Select **Global** as the application.
6. Select **System user** as the Run As user.
7. Create the flow.
8. Add a Service Catalog trigger.
9. Add the Create Catalog Task action.
10. Use the Requested Item Record.
11. Set the short description **Laptop need to Configured**
12. Set the description **Laptop need to Configured**
13. Set Assignment Group **Hardware**
14. Set Approval: **Approved**
15. Save the flow.
16. Activate the flow.

Milestone 2 – Flow Assignment

Activity: Assign Flow to Standard Laptop Catalog Item

1. Open ServiceNow.
2. Search for Maintain Items.
3. Open Maintain Items.

4. Search for Standard Laptop.
5. Open the Standard Laptop catalog item.
6. Open Process Engine.
7. Remove unnecessary existing automations.
8. Add the Standard Laptop Task flow.
9. Save the record.

Milestone 3 – Service Catalog

Activity: Place Standard Laptop Order

1. Open Service Catalog.
2. Select Hardware.
3. Select Standard Laptop.
4. Click Order Now.
5. Open the generated request.
6. Check the request status.
7. Open the Approvers section.
8. Approve the request.
9. Open the Requested Item.
10. Scroll to Catalog Tasks.
11. Open the generated Catalog Task.
12. Verify the task details.

Expected Result

The Catalog Task should contain:

<i>Field</i>	<i>Expected Value</i>
<i>Short Description</i>	Laptop need to Configured
<i>Description</i>	Laptop need to Configured
<i>Assignment Group</i>	Hardware
<i>Approval</i>	Approved

7. Functional Requirements

<i>S.No</i>	<i>Functional Requirement</i>
1	User can access the Standard Laptop catalog item.
2	User can submit a Standard Laptop request.
3	Request can go through the approval process.
4	Flow is triggered through the Service Catalog.
5	Catalog Task is automatically created after approval.
6	Task description is automatically updated.
7	Task is automatically assigned to Hardware.
8	IT team can track the generated Catalog Task.

8. Testing

<i>Test Case</i>	<i>Name</i>	<i>Input</i>	<i>Expected Result</i>	<i>Status</i>
1	Standard Laptop Request	User selects Standard Laptop and clicks Order Now.	Standard Laptop request is created.	Passed
2	Request Approval	Approve the Standard Laptop request.	Request status changes to approved.	Passed
3	Catalog Task Creation	Approved Standard Laptop request.	Flow automatically creates a Catalog Task.	Passed
4	Hardware Assignment	Automatically generated Catalog Task.	Assignment group is Hardware.	Passed
5	Description Update	Generated Catalog Task.	Short description and description show "Laptop need to Configured."	Passed

9. Expected Benefits

- Reduces manual task creation.
- Reduces procurement processing time.
- Ensures configuration tasks are generated after approval.
- Automatically routes work to the Hardware team.
- Reduces the possibility of task assignment being missed.
- Improves visibility of procurement tasks.

- Provides a more streamlined experience for users.
- Improves IT resource utilization.

10. Conclusion

The Streamlining IT Procurement: Automating Standard Laptop Orders with Flow Designer project successfully automates the standard laptop procurement workflow in ServiceNow.

The implemented Flow Designer automation creates a Catalog Task after the Standard Laptop request is approved, updates the task with the required configuration description, and assigns it to the Hardware assignment group. This reduces manual intervention and helps ensure that laptop configuration activities are initiated promptly.

The project demonstrates how ServiceNow Flow Designer can be used to automate IT procurement activities and improve the efficiency of service request fulfillment.

11. Future Enhancements

- Automatic notification to the Hardware team.
- Email notification to the requester when the laptop is ready.
- Automatic task priority based on request urgency.
- SLA tracking for laptop configuration.
- Automated inventory availability checking.
- Automatic escalation for overdue configuration tasks.
- Reporting dashboard for laptop procurement requests.